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EXAMPLE DOCUMENT. Thalovane Components (Pty) Ltd is a fictitious company. Every company, person, address, date, figure and reference number in this example is made up; only the Care Net letterhead and any public emergency number are real. For guidance only; not a document to sign or rely on.

Example for a Health and Safety File, Section O: Records and retention

Records Retention Schedule

Health and safety records, Gqeberha plant, approved 3 August 2026

About this example	Detail
Company in the example	Thalovane Components (Pty) Ltd, a fictitious company
Where it is filed	Section O: Records and retention
Published by	Care Net Consultants, as guidance for companies building a Health and Safety File

How to use this example

This example shows the form and content Care Net recommends for this document in a Health and Safety File. Adapt it to your company, your sites and your appointments; your registered Health and Safety practitioner confirms it before your File is released. Not legal advice.

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Records Retention Schedule

Health and safety records, Gqeberha plant, approved 3 August 2026

1. Purpose

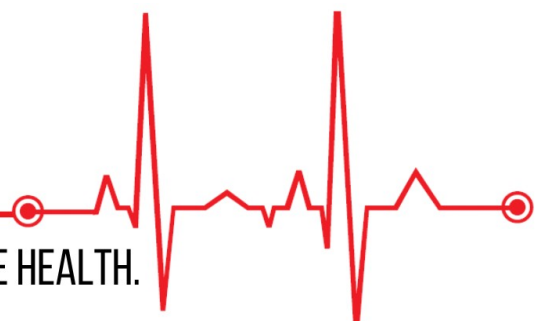
This schedule sets, for every type of health and safety record we keep, why we keep it, where it is held, who may see it, how long we keep it and how we dispose of it. The Health and Safety Manager, Busisiwe Tshabalala, reviews it every year and whenever the law or our operations change.

2. POPIA purpose note

Many of these records hold personal information about our employees, contractors and visitors. Under the Protection of Personal Information Act (POPIA), we collect and keep this information only to meet our health and safety duties under the OHS Act and COIDA and to protect the people on our site. We keep it for the period the applicable regulations set, or the practitioner sets where no regulation sets one, and no longer; restrict access to the people named below, keep it secure and dispose of it safely. Medical records are held by the occupational health practitioner; our File holds only the fitness outcome (fit, fit with restrictions, unfit). Employees may ask to see their own records by writing to the Information Officer, Ruan de Villiers.



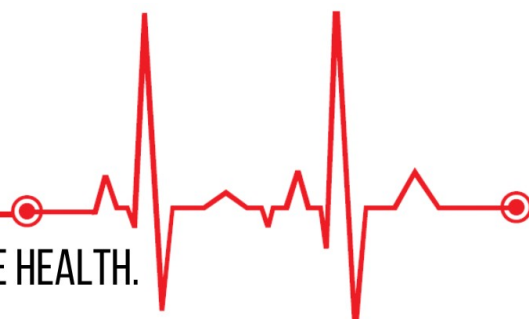
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3. Retention schedule

How the retention column works. Where regulations set how long a record type is kept, the column says **as the applicable regulations set**, and the registered Health and Safety practitioner confirms which regulations apply to our agents, equipment and activities. Records of exposure to hazardous agents and of medical surveillance are kept for the long periods those regulations set, because disease from an exposure can appear many years later. **As the practitioner sets** is used only for record types no regulation covers.

Record type	Purpose	Where held	Access	Retention period	Disposal
File index and legal register	Show how we meet the OHS Act	Cabinet HS1, Health and Safety office; scanned copy on the server	Management, representatives, inspectors	As the practitioner sets (no regulation sets a period)	Shred; delete copy
Written appointments, including the section 16(2) assignment	Prove who holds each duty	Cabinet HS1	Management, the appointee, inspectors	As the applicable regulations set where they cover it; otherwise as the practitioner sets	Shred
Risk assessments for hazardous chemical agents, hazardous biological agents, lead, asbestos, noise and other regulated agents, with their safe work procedures	Record the assessed exposure and its controls	Server, Health and Safety folder	All employees, read only	As the applicable regulations set for the agent	Delete



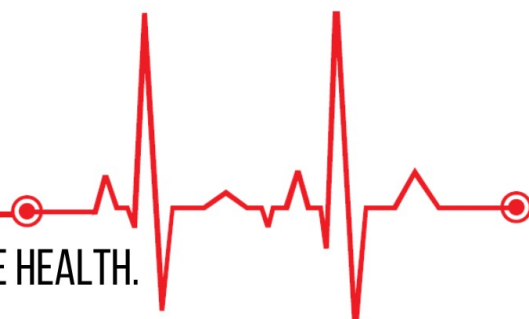
Record type	Purpose	Where held	Access	Retention period	Disposal
Other risk assessments and safe work procedures	Record hazards and controls	Server, Health and Safety folder	All employees, read only	As the applicable regulations set where they cover it; otherwise as the practitioner sets	Delete
Occupational hygiene and exposure monitoring reports, including air monitoring	Show that exposure was measured and controlled	Cabinet HS2 and the server	Management, representatives, the occupational medical practitioner, inspectors	As the applicable regulations set for the agent	Shred; delete
Training and induction records	Prove competence	Human resources, locked cabinet	Human resources, the employee	As the applicable regulations set where they cover it; otherwise as the practitioner sets	Shred
Certificates of fitness (outcome only)	Confirm who is fit for which work	Human resources, locked cabinet	Human resources, the employee, the supervisor	As the applicable regulations set for the exposure	Shred
Medical surveillance and clinical records	Monitor the health of exposed employees	Occupational health practitioner, never in our File	The practitioner and the employee	As the applicable regulations set for the hazard	Practitioner
Incident reports and investigations	Learn from incidents; report under COIDA	Cabinet HS2 and the server	Management, representatives, inspectors	As the OHS Act, COIDA and the applicable regulations set	Shred; delete
Committee minutes and inspection reports	Show consultation and follow up	Server, Committee folder	Committee members; employees on request	As the applicable regulations set	Delete



Record type	Purpose	Where held	Access	Retention period	Disposal
Equipment inspection registers	Prove equipment is inspected	Maintenance office	Maintenance, inspectors	As the applicable regulations set for the equipment	Shred
Contractor Files and section 37(2) agreements	Control contractors on site	Cabinet HS2	Management, the contractor	As the applicable regulations set where they cover it; otherwise as the practitioner sets	Return or shred
Visitor registers	Know who is on site in an emergency	Security gate, then Health and Safety office	Security, management	As the practitioner sets (no regulation sets a period)	Shred

4. Storage, access and disposal

- Paper records are kept in locked cabinets; only the people in the access column hold keys.
- Electronic records are kept in folders with access limited to the same people, and the server is backed up.
- No record is destroyed while an inspection, claim, investigation or legal matter about it is open.
- Every disposal is recorded in the disposal log: record type, dates covered, method, date and the person who did it.



Health and Safety Manager

Busisiwe Tshabalala, Date: _____

Information Officer

Ruan de Villiers, Date: _____

End of the example. The company, people and records in it are fictitious; the cover page explains how to use it.



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